

1. Will the Q&A section of the landing page be confidential, anonymous, or will there be people who can see who's asked the question?

Only questions and answers will be shared, without disclosing the identity of the questioner.

2. When will the project teams be assembled?

Over the next few weeks, the Cabinet will be in contact with the Faculty Committee, Staff Council, the Student Learning and Formation Committee, and the Formation Team to identify team members for participation. If you are interested in participating, please feel free to reach out to your Cabinet member or a member of one of the committees or teams mentioned.

3. Can you give some additional context to the following action item?

Cabinet Functioning: Examine current patterns of leadership and identify next step actions that will strengthen how they work together and how they provide leadership to Asbury. Note: The Cabinet includes the President and Vice-Presidents.

The survey revealed trust issues with leadership at the seminary. The Cabinet is focused on evaluating its leadership and how it engages across the institution and started this work during a retreat on August 6. Cabinet members are examining how their current patterns of leadership have influenced these outcomes and are beginning to identify next step actions that will strengthen how they work together and how they provide leadership to Asbury. The Cabinet is working through seven questions that contribute to a healthy leadership team. This work will continue throughout the fall and will also continue upon Dr. Tennent's return from his sabbatical.

4. Are we aiming to ensure that this work continues for the next 100 years, rather than just integrating something temporarily or hosting an event?

There is a direct correlation between the level of engagement within an organization and its ability to make meaningful impact and realize its potential. A primary goal of this process is to establish organizational health as a top priority and not limited to a specific season. Just like there are rhythms and disciplines that lead to good personal health, there are rhythms and disciplines that lead to good organizational health. The process we have been involved in will be repeated in 2024, encompassing the Best Christian Workplaces survey, Discovery Groups, and action plan development and implementation.

- 5. Can we define the specific culture we are aiming to achieve at Asbury?
When considering culture, there are core values associated with it. What exactly is the desired work culture we're striving for at Asbury?**

One challenge we face is the absence of a shared understanding of what it means to be a community here at Asbury. We aim to address this through this ongoing process of defining our desired culture. As we move forward, one of our central values will be transparency – the commitment to honesty and openness. Our overarching objective is to foster a flourishing culture with engaged staff, faculty, and administrators, all aligned with our mission. This culture is something we are collectively shaping as one unified body.

- 6. I recall Dr. Tennent mentioning that he was contemplating whether to continue after the Sabbatical. Is there a specific point in the semester when we'll have a definite decision and a clear plan for his transition back?**

From Board Chair Karen Thomas: Dr. Tennent is on a sabbatical being stewarded by the Executive Committee of the Board of Trustees. The current plan in place is for Dr. Tennent to rest, reflect, and renew in order to return and lead Asbury forward.

- 7. How can we ensure that there is both room and encouragement for us to participate in the project teams?**

The challenge is to balance these projects while handling existing workloads. The project teams play a crucial role in advancing our workplace culture. Clear expectations between team members and their managers will be established to ensure everyone understands work requirements and project team commitments, promoting clarity and alignment.